Project Management Assignment

Project Management is the practice of applying knowledge, skills, tools, and techniques to plan and complete a temporary task to meet a specific goal. Every project is balanced by three main factors: scope, time, and cost. It is often hard to meet all 3 as they are normally inversely correlated.

A project is anything that is not a daily operation and something that has a clear finish line or goal. Some attributes include being temporary, unique, goal-driven, progressively elaborated, and stakeholder-backed. There is also risk to be addressed before beginning a project that relates back to the scope, time, and cost of the entire operation from start to finish.

Benefits of project management include turning a big and messy goal into a plan that people can follow. It is common to make a schedule before beginning that shows a timeline and who will complete what tasks by what times. This, ideally, keeps the team on budget and prevents the operations from expanding too far off task. It also improves communication since everyone is informed about their role and responsibilities for the duration of the project. Documentation should also be taken throughout the entire project to keep track of tasks completed and lessons learned. This allows the project manager to backtrack if needed and fix weaknesses within the project.

Some essential project management skills are: Budgeting and cost control, Risk identification and planning, scope management, team communication, and leadership

The CLEAR Method is a goal-setting framework that states that all ‘CLEAR’ goals should be collaborative, limited, emotional, appreciable, and refinable. This means that they should be owned and run by the team rather than an individual, limited to a narrow scope and time to keep the team focused, emotionally tied to something that the people actually care about, broken down into small steps where progress can be seen, and open to constant updates as new information is received.

There is a methodology called Lean Methodology that I believe comes from Toyota. This focuses on delivering maximum value to the customer while cutting waste in time, cost, resources, and more without removing value to the product.

The five principles are as follows: Define value from the customer's point of view, find the value stream, create flow within the work to avoid bottlenecks, establish pull so work starts only when there is real demand, and pursue perfection through continuous improvement.

This methodology also lists eight common wastes: defects, overproduction, waiting, non-utilized talent, transportation, inventory, motion, and extra processing.

This methodology stuck with me as I have seen it as a required class for my major in Engineering Technology, CNSM. This major includes TECH 145 Lean Methodology. Mapping a value stream seems a lot like a traceroute in networking, where you view each hop around the network and see where the delay is coming from.